



Smartwatches

Not just time-keepers anymore

Smartwatches continue to dominate the wearable tech market in India in 2024, with brands fiercely competing across every price segment. The price-sensitive Indian consumer demands maximum value for their money, pushing manufacturers to pack more features into their digital timepieces while keeping prices competitive. This unrelenting demand has created an intensely competitive environment for both premium smartwatch makers and budget-friendly brands alike. If there were any lingering doubts about this trend, they were thoroughly dispelled during our rigorous testing for the 2024 Digit Zero1 and Best Buy awards.

Winner and Best Buy: Apple Watch Series 10

The Apple Watch Series 10 has set a new benchmark for performance, taking the crown as one of the most accurate and reliable smartwatches of the year. The watch proved to be exceptionally accurate, scoring 95 in a 2 KM walk test and 81 in exercise tracking for the same distance. Step tracking was flawless with 100% accuracy, a figure that no other smartwatch in this category has achieved so consistently. Heart rate and SpO2 tracking also delivered perfect 100% accuracy, reflecting Apple's commitment to precision engineering in health monitoring. The display brightness peaked at 782 nits, making it one of the brightest and most readable screens we've tested, even in direct sunlight. This performance outpaces most competitors and adds a layer of convenience for outdoor use. Meanwhile, the haptic feedback scored an impressive 4.5, ensuring a tactile and responsive experience during navigation and notifications. When coming to the Best Buy Award, Apple Watch Series 10 stood tall as well. At first glance, the premium price tag of the Apple Watch Series 10 might seem daunting. However, when considering the sheer quality and comprehensive features it brings to the table, the watch emerges as a remarkable value-for-money proposition.

The build quality of the Series 10 is impeccable, with sapphire crystal glass protecting the display and a durable aluminium or titanium frame offering excellent resistance to wear and tear. We got the aluminium variant. Combined with the watch's sleek aesthetics, this makes it not only a powerful device but also a statement accessory. The new S10 processor under the hood ensures fluid performance, whether you're multitasking between apps or navigating through the polished watchOS 11 interface. Battery life has seen significant improvement as well, comfortably lasting 36 hours on a single charge during moderate use. While it's not the longest in the market, Apple's fast-charging technology ensures you're never left waiting too long for a full recharge. Finally, the Series 10's integration with



Apple Watch Series 10
Price: ₹49,990

Apple's ecosystem amplifies its value *cough* if you prefer to live in a walled garden *cough*.

Runner-Up: Samsung Galaxy Watch Ultra

The Samsung Galaxy Watch Ultra nearly claimed the crown for the Best Performing Smartwatch of the year, coming tantalisingly close to the Apple Watch Series 10 with a mere 0.26-point difference in overall performance. We rigorously tested the Galaxy Watch Ultra across various metrics and it delivered outstanding results, proving itself a top-tier contender in its category. In our tests, the Galaxy Watch Ultra scored a remarkable 99% accuracy in a 2 KM walk and 99.02% in heart rate tracking, matching some of the most accurate smartwatches available. Its SpO2 tracking was equally impressive, clocking in at 98.98%, while its step tracking accuracy was recorded at 90.71%. While it slightly lagged behind the Apple Watch Series 10 in exercise accuracy (71.52% vs. 81%), it more than held its ground in other critical metrics. The display brightness peaked at 522 nits, falling short of the Apple Watch Series 10's 782 nits, but still ensuring excellent visibility in most conditions. The Galaxy Watch Ultra's haptics, could use some refinement to match the intensity of the Apple Watch Series 10. Despite these small gaps, the Galaxy Watch Ultra proved itself a powerhouse of precision and reliability. Its solid titanium build, extensive feature set, and seamless Android integration make it an exceptional choice for the users who can extract the unhinged performance of this watch. Ultimately, while the Apple Watch Series 10 retained its lead with slightly better accuracy across the board, the Samsung Galaxy Watch Ultra stands as a close competitor, delivering a stellar performance in almost every metric we tested.



Samsung Galaxy Watch Ultra
Price: ₹39,990

—Sativik Pandey | satvik@digit.in